

(12) **United States Plant Patent**
Tristram

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(54) **GAURA PLANT NAMED ‘WALSILFOU’**

(50) Latin Name: *Gaura lindheimeri*
Varietal Denomination: **Walsilfou**

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(57) **ABSTRACT**

A new cultivar of *Gaura* named ‘Walsilfou’ that is charac-
terized by dense compact habit throughout the season,
variegated cream-green foliage and single sterile flowers
which open light pink in color becoming pure white in color
when fully open.

2 Drawing Sheets

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Genus and species: *Gaura lindheimeri*.
Variety denomination: ‘Walsilfou’.

BACKGROUND OF THE NEW PLANT

The present invention relates to a new and distinct variety
of butterfly bush grown for use as an ornamental plant in
planted containers, garden borders, and for mass landscape
planting. The new cultivar is known botanically as *Gaura*
lindheimeri and will be referred to hereinafter by the cultivar
name ‘Walsilfou’.

In spring 2015, the inventor observed within a growing
crop of his white-flowered variety of *Gaura* Plant Named
‘Walsnofou’ (U.S. Plant Pat. No. 19,376) a naturally occur-
ring whole plant mutation which exhibited gold-yellow and
green variegated foliage. The growing crop was in produc-
tion out-of-doors at the inventor’s nursery in Arundel, West
Sussex, United Kingdom. The inventor removed this gold-
yellow and green mutated plant for further evaluation.

In summer 2015, the inventor observed that one branch of
the gold-yellow and green variegated plant mutation exhib-
ited a contrasting cream and green variegation. The inventor
successfully rooted and established plants from vegetative
stem cuttings taken from the cream and green variegated
branch. The inventor has established that the discovered
sport, ‘Walsilfou’ reproduces true to type in successive
generations of asexual reproduction, without any reversion
either to the gold-yellow variegation of its immediate sport
parent, or to the all green foliage of the original parent
‘Walsnofou’.

All propagations have been carried out in an unheated
greenhouse at the inventor’s nursery in Arundel, United
Kingdom using the method of stem cuttings. The inventor
has confirmed that ‘Walsilfou’ is stable and reproduces true
to type in successive generations of asexual reproduction.

SUMMARY

The following traits have been repeatedly observed and
represent the distinguishing characteristics of ‘Walsilfou’.

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‘Walsilfou’ has not been tested under all possible conditions
and phenotypic differences may be observed with variations
in environmental, climatic, and cultural conditions, without
however, any variance in genotype.

1. ‘Walsilfou’ exhibits dense compact habit which is
maintained throughout the season.
2. ‘Walsilfou’ exhibits variegated cream-green foliage.
3. ‘Walsilfou’ bears sterile white flowers continuously
from spring until fall.
4. ‘Walsilfou’ is hardy in USDA Zone 5.
5. Excluding its flowers, ‘Walsilfou’ reaches 30 cm in
height and 30 cm in width after 12 months in a 1 gallon
container.
6. Excluding its flowers, ‘Walsilfou’ reaches 35 cm in
height and 40 cm in width at maturity when planted in
the landscape.

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE PHOTOGRAPHS

The accompanying color photographs illustrate the over-
all appearance of ‘Walsilfou’ showing the colors as true as
it is reasonably possible to obtain in colored reproductions
of this type. Colors in the drawing may differ from the color
values cited in the detailed botanical description, which
accurately describe the actual colors of the new variety
‘Walsilfou’.

FIG. 1 depicts an individual plant of ‘Walsilfou’ in full
bloom. The illustrated plant is one year old and is growing
in a 2 gallon pot outdoors in Oxnard, Calif. The drawing has
been made from a photograph taken in mid-July in Oxnard,
Calif. No growth regulators have been used.

FIG. 2 presents a close-up view of a single flower of
‘Walsilfou’ when fully open.

BOTANICAL DESCRIPTION OF THE PLANT

The following is a detailed botanical description of the
new *Gaura* variety named ‘Walsilfou’. Data was collected in

Oxnard, Calif. in mid-July of 2018 from 12-month-old plants that were grown in 2 gallon containers outdoors in full sun. The growing requirements are similar to other *Gaura*. Color determinations were made in accordance with The 2007 Royal Horticultural Society Colour Chart from London England, except where general color terms of ordinary dictionary significance are used.

Classification:

Family.—Onagraceae.

Genus.—*Gaura*.

Species.—*Lindheimeri*.

Common name.—*Gaura*, Beeblossom.

Parentage: Second generation mutation sport of 'Walsnofou' (U.S. Plant Pat. No. 19,376).

Plant:

Commercial classification.—Perennial.

Use.—Ornamental plant for containers, garden borders and planting in the landscape.

Special cultural requirements.—None.

Susceptibility to pests and disease.—None.

Root system.—Fine and fibrous.

Drought tolerance.—Drought tolerant once established in the landscape.

Bloom period.—Continuously from late spring until fall.

Habit.—Dense compact habit.

Dimensions (excluding inflorescences).—30 cm in height and 30 cm in width.

Hardiness.—USDA Zone 5.

Propagation.—Stem cuttings.

Time to develop roots.—2 to 3 weeks from initial cutting.

Crop time.—6 weeks are required to produce a 3 cm to 5 cm starter plant from insertion of an unrooted cutting. A further 10 to 12 weeks are required to produce a flowering plant after potting into a 1 or 2 gallon container.

Stems:

Shape.—Cylindrical.

Color.—Emerges 139C becoming 182B at maturity.

Texture.—Stiff.

Dimensions.—20 cm to 25 cm in length and 3 mm in diameter.

Surface.—Pubescent.

Internode length (average).—0.50 cm.

Leaves:

Arrangement.—Alternate.

Shape.—Oblanceolate.

Division.—Simple.

Apex.—Acute.

Base.—Attenuate.

Venation pattern.—Pinnate, midrib depressed on adaxial surface, raised on abaxial surface.

Vein color (both surfaces).—139D.

Margins.—Entire.

Attachment.—Sessile.

Leaf surface (both surfaces).—Puberulent.

Leaf appearance.—Young leaves glossy, otherwise matte.

Leaf length (average).—5 cm.

Leaf width (average).—1 cm.

Leaf color (adaxial surface).—Predominantly 143C with some areas N138C towards margin.

Leaf color (abaxial surface).—N138B and N138C both present.

Leaf margin variegation (both surfaces).—10A on younger leaves becoming 10C or 10D as leaf ages. Variegation extends approximately 1.0 mm to 1.5 mm from margin edge.

Fragrance.—None observed.

Inflorescence:

Inflorescence.—Terminal raceme consisting of single flowers.

Flower quantity per inflorescence.—In any one day, 1 or 2 flowers are freshly open, and each raceme bears approximately 20 flowers over time.

Flower quantity per plant.—Approximately 50 freshly open flowers per day.

Lastingness of flower.—Fully open for 1 to 2 days.

Flower depth.—1.5 cm.

Flower diameter.—3.75 cm. Flower color (petals, sepals) are colored light pink, ranging between 65D and 65B, at bud emergence, becoming pure white, NN155D, when fully open.

Flower shape.—Clawed after bud emergence, opening flat.

Flowers persistence.—Persistent for 1 to 2 days after open flowering, then self-cleaning.

Aspect.—Facing outward.

Flower bud:

Bud dimensions.—1.5 cm in length and 4 mm in diameter.

Bud arrangement.—Buds are produced at the apex of the raceme, arranged in clusters of 5 to 7 buds.

Bud shape.—Cylindrical.

Bud color.—At emergence, 160C, then becoming 50B at apex and base, and then 50B throughout (immediately prior to petal emergence).

Bud surface.—Pubescent.

Bud apex.—Acute.

Bud base.—Truncate.

Corolla:

Petals.—Four in number, fan-like arrangement.

Petal shape.—Obovate.

Petal color (adaxial and abaxial surfaces).—65D and 65B at bud emergence, becoming pure white, NN155D, when fully open.

Petal dimensions.—2 cm in length and 1 cm in width.

Petals fused or unfused.—Unfused.

Petal margin.—Entire.

Petal apex.—Broadly acute.

Petal base.—Attenuated.

Petal surfaces (adaxial and abaxial).—Glabrous.

Calyx:

Calyx.—Tubular, lightly pubescent.

Sepals.—4, reflexed.

Sepals fused or unfused.—Unfused.

Sepal color.—N66B at emergence, becoming pale pink N155B.

Sepal dimensions.—1.5 cm in length and 1.5 mm to 2.0 mm in width.

Sepal surface.—Puberulent.

Pedicel:

Pedicel dimensions.—0.50 cm in length and 1.50 mm in width.

Pedicel color.—146D initially, quickly becoming 178A.

Pedicel shape.—Cylindrical.

Pedicel surface.—Glabrous.

Peduncle:

Peduncle dimensions.—20 cm to 30 cm in length and 2 mm to 3 mm in diameter.

Peduncle shape.—Cylindrical.

Peduncle color.—144A.

Peduncle surface.—Glabrous.

Flower fragrance.—None observed.

Reproductive organs:

Stamens.—Eight in number.

Stamen color.—NN155D.

Stamen length (average).—2.10 cm.

Anther length.—3 mm.

Anther color.—199A.

Pollen color.—163C.

Pollen quantity.—Moderate.

Pistil.—One in number.

Pistil length.—2 cm.

Pistil color.—155B.

Pistil shape.—Filament.

Stigma shape.—4-lobed.

Stigma color.—NN155D.

Stigma width.—3 mm.

Ovary position.—Inferior.

Ovary color.—138D.

Ovary shape.—Ovoid.

Ovary dimensions.—3 mm in height and 2 mm in width.

5 Seed: No seed observed to date.

COMPARISON WITH PARENTAL LINES AND
KNOWN VARIETY

10 'Walsilfou' may be compared with its original sport parent 'Walsnofou' as follows. Whereas 'Walsnofou' bears entirely green foliage without any variegation, the foliage of 'Walsilfou' is green with cream-colored marginal variegation.

15 The closest variety of *Gaura* known to the inventor is the variegated variety 'Corrie's Gold' (unpatented) which also bears white flowers. In comparison with 'Walsilfou', 'Corrie's Gold' has a more open and spreading habit. 'Corrie's Gold' achieves 90 cm in height and 70 cm in width.

20 I claim:

1. A new and distinct cultivar of *Gaura* plant named 'Walsilfou', as described and illustrated herein.

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FIG. 1



FIG. 2